EXPERIMENT 4

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Create a prototype with familiar and unfamiliar navigation elements. Evaluate ease of use with different user groups using proto.io

Familiar Navigation

Screen 1:

1. Hamburger Menu (☰) – Top Left Corner

- Recognized icon used to open a side navigation drawer.
- Clicking reveals a menu panel with options such as Search, Notifications, and Help.
- Commonly implemented in both Android and iOS applications.
- Users intuitively understand it provides access to additional navigation options.

2. Profile Section – Top Center (User Name & Profile Image)

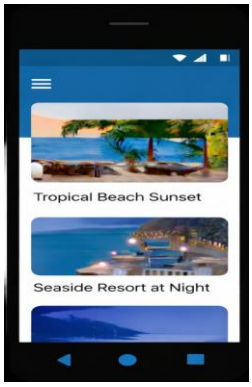
- Displays the user's profile picture and name.
- Indicates the currently logged-in user.
- Tapping this section typically leads to account details or profile editing.
- Standard layout in social media and content-based apps**.**

3. Tab Navigation (Posts | Stats | Settings) – Below Profile

- A widely used tab-based navigation pattern.
- Enables switching between sections without leaving the screen.
- Posts → Shows uploaded content.

- Stats → Displays analytics or activity data.
- Settings → Provides configuration options.
- The highlighted tab indicates the active section, improving clarity and usability.

Screen 2:



4. Scrollable Content Layout

The posts such as “Tropical Beach Sunset” and “Seaside Resort at Night” are arranged in a vertical list format. Vertical scrolling is a fundamental interaction pattern in mobile devices.

Users naturally scroll down to view more content. Because scrolling is universally understood, no learning effort is required. This makes content browsing smooth and efficient.

5. Search Functionality

The application includes a search icon represented by a magnifying glass. When selected, it opens a search screen with a text field labeled “Type something.”

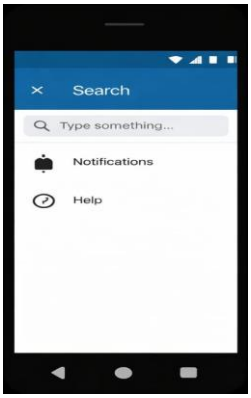
Search functionality is a core feature in most applications. Users instantly recognize the magnifying glass symbol and understand that it allows them to find specific content quickly. The placement and design follow common mobile UI standards.

6. Close Icon on Search Screen

On the search page, an “X” icon appears at the top left. This icon is universally used to close a screen or exit a temporary page.

Users are familiar with this symbol from websites, apps, and pop-up windows. It provides a clear and simple way to return to the previous screen.

Screen 3:



7. **Notification Icon**

The bell icon represents notifications. When selected, it leads to alerts or updates related to the user. This icon is widely used across social media, e-commerce, and service-based apps.

Because the bell symbol is globally recognized, users immediately understand its purpose without needing instructions.

8. **Help Option in Navigation Drawer**

The Help option appears inside the side navigation menu. It allows users to access support information, guidance, or frequently asked questions.

Providing help inside the menu is a standard design approach. Users expect support options to be placed either in settings or in the navigation drawer.

9. **Visual Hierarchy and Layout Structure**

The application follows a structured layout pattern: header section, navigation tabs, and content area. This hierarchical arrangement guides the user's attention from top to bottom.

The consistent spacing, alignment, and positioning of elements create a predictable user experience. Predictability is a key factor in familiar navigation design.

10. **Android System Navigation Controls**

At the bottom of the screen, standard Android navigation buttons are visible: Back, Home, and Recent Apps.

These are system-level controls that allow users to exit the app, return to the home screen, or switch between applications. Because these controls are part of the Android operating system, users are already comfortable using them.

Unfamiliar Navigation

Screen 1:

1. **Floating Circular Action Menu – Bottom Right Corner**

In the third screen, there is a large circular button with a plus symbol, surrounded by other smaller circular icons such as Messages and Settings. This appears to be an expandable floating action menu.

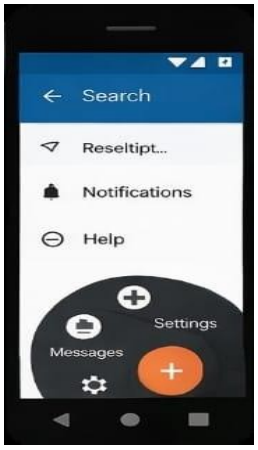
2. **Curved Overlay Menu Design**

The circular menu appears inside a curved black background shape. This is not a standard Android layout pattern.

3. **Side Navigation Icons Without Text Labels**

In the side drawer, some icons appear vertically (such as profile, stats, and other symbols). If these icons are displayed without clear text labels, users may not immediately understand their exact function.

Screen 2:



4. **“Reseltipt…” or Truncated Menu Text**

In the search menu screen, one of the options appears partially cut off or unclear (example: “Reseltipt…”).

5. **Multiple Access Points for Settings**

Settings appear in multiple places:

- As a tab in the profile section
- As an icon inside the floating circular menu

6. Mixed Navigation Patterns

The application uses:

- Tab navigation
- Side drawer navigation
- Floating action menu

Screen 3:

7. **Abstract Icons in Floating Menu**

Some icons inside the circular action menu (such as camera or message-style symbols) may not have text labels next to them.

8. **Layered Navigation Flow**

The app allows navigation through multiple layers:
Profile → Tabs → Search → Side Drawer → Floating Menu

If users are not careful, they may lose track of their current position in the navigation hierarchy. This layered structure can be unfamiliar compared to simpler apps with limited navigation depth.

conclusion

The mobile application interface demonstrates a combination of familiar and unfamiliar navigation elements. Familiar components such as the hamburger menu, tab navigation (Posts, Stats, Settings), search icon, notification icon, and scrollable content layout follow standard mobile design principles. These elements reduce the learning curve and allow users to interact with the application confidently and efficiently.